

CLIENT	ENGAGEMENT TYPE	DATE	CONSULTANT	STATUS
[REDACTED]	Forensic Audit + Fix	Q2 2026	Mehedi Hasan	● RESOLVED

SENDING ENVIRONMENT

Platform	Workspace	Monthly Volume	Active Domains	Warmup Tool
GoHighLevel	Google Workspace	[REDACTED]	[REDACTED]	Yes (3rd-party)

REPORTED SYMPTOMS

Inbox placement declining across all domains over 6–8 weeks

Transactional and marketing emails missing inbox — customer re-engagement revenue affected

MXToolbox, mail-tester, and GoHighLevel in-platform checks all reporting authentication PASS

No bounce codes returned — failures silent

ROOT CAUSE IDENTIFIED

FINDING 01

CRITICAL

DMARC ALIGNMENT FAILURE — SILENT

GoHighLevel routes outbound through Google Workspace SMTP relay. Google's relay signs DKIM with gapssmtp.com (relay subdomain), not the client's From domain. DMARC alignment requires DKIM signing domain to match the From: header domain. Mismatch causes silent DMARC failure – no bounce code, no validator flag, no delivery error returned to sender.

FINDING 02

HIGH

SPF: NONE — RELAY IPs NOT INCLUDED

Google Workspace outbound relay IPs not present in the domain's SPF record. SPF check returning NONE on all outbound mail routed through the relay path.

FINDING 03

NOTE

STANDARD VALIDATORS BLIND TO THIS FAILURE

MXToolbox, mail-tester, and GoHighLevel's in-platform authentication checker all reported PASS. Failure only visible in raw message headers (Gmail 'Show Original' → Authentication-Results block). No tool that tests originating sends – rather than relay paths – will surface this failure.

FIX SPECIFICATION + IMPLEMENTATION

[+] Configure custom sending domain inside GoHighLevel – authenticate directly on client domain (not relay subdomain).

[+] DKIM now signs with client domain: d=[REDACTED]. Alignment achieved on From: header domain.

[+] SPF record updated: include Google outbound SMTP IP ranges for relay path. SPF result: PASS.

[+] DMARC policy: p=quarantine with active RUA reporting to [REDACTED] – forensic visibility enabled.

VERIFIED OUTCOME

SPF	DKIM	DMARC	Inbox Placement	Verification Method
PASS	PASS (client domain – aligned)	PASS	Restored	Gmail 'Show Original' headers

Standard validators reported PASS throughout the engagement. The failure was only visible in raw message headers. Customer email fully recovered. Re-engagement campaigns restored to inbox.